Fall, 2004 Volume VII, Issue 1

The Mountainside

www.coolfontmountainside.com



Richard Kaufman, Dilys Parry and Jay Copeland at one of our wonderful potlucks.

Update on Mountainside News

The Annual Meeting

The annual meeting of the Coolfont Mountainside Association July 19 highlighted many issues important to all members of CMA. Those included the election of new board members and the future of Coolfont Resort. We also heard the treasurer's, water and sewer and road reports.



Jim Thompson

Many CMA members expressed concern about the possible sale of Coolfont Resort; a decrease in property values, the impact on the environment, losing the sense of serenity of our community, and increased building and population density.

Members also expressed some positive aspects of the possible sale. Those include increased property values and a more welcoming physical atmosphere at the lodge, spa and green space.

Three representatives from CRI, George Haynes, President of CRI, Sam Collins and Jenny McCann spoke at the meeting to inform members of plans for sale, development and upgrade of CRI. They answered the many questions members had and queried members on what upgrades they would like to see at Coolfont Resort.

The CMA board will appoint a Task Force to partner with CRI to see that the interests of homeowners be transmitted to CRI and their management team..

Elections were held and CMA filled the three open board positions. The new board members are: Jim Thompson, Carroll Yingling and Jean Cohen.

Lois Copeland

CMA Board Meetings and Potluck Dinners!

November 13

Board: CMA Office 10 am

Firewise Day 12 noon

The Barn

Potluck: Yingling— J 2

December 10

Board: CMA Office 10 am

Potluck: Brydges Q 4

January 15, 2005

Board: CMA Office 10 am

Potluck: **Meet your neighbors, volunteer for a potluck**

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CMA Board:

Jim Thompson: President

Carroll Yingling: Vice President

Paul Kagan: Treasurer

Cindy Van Meter: Secretary

Elmer Broxson

Hallie Kerr

Jean Cohen

Meet the New CMA President: Jim Thompson

I am honored to be your new president and will work hard for the betterment of CMA members and the association. Recognizing that I have large shoes to fill after four years of Richard Kaufman's wonderful leadership, I pledge that this Board will work to honor the vision of CMA , be good stewards of our CMA resources and maintain harmony on the mountainside. There is much to do over the next year and I want to address some of those major tasks. You have elected an excellent and dedicated Board over the last two years.

See opposite sidebar for list of new CMA board.

Volunteers

I profusely and sincerely thank all those who have volunteered to serve in various ways. But we always need more help! Continued p3

West Virginia Rural Water Association Meeting— by Jean Cohen

The West Virginia Rural Water Association (WVRWA) held its 19th annual training and technical conference on September 12-15 at the Canaan Valley resort in West Virginia. Elmer Broxson, John Hobday and I represented CMA (Coolfont Mountainside Association) at this meeting.

The meeting offered "outstanding classes with industry experts and regulatory officials". Twenty-two classes/workshops were provided. The theme of this year's conference was "Foundations for Success."

West Virginia will begin a State water use survey next year one of the presenters announced. Another said that there is a "portable emergency response plant." It provides water treatment to communities in the event of an emergency.



Keep our water as pure as the softly falling snow!

The workshops addressed a variety of issues of concern to water system operators. The topics ranged from those that were highly technical to those that were of interest to administrators. I attended several workshops: Utility Billing, Maintaining your PC, and Collection Procedures.

Coolfont Mountainside Arts and Crafts Tour – November 6 and 7

Want to do your holiday shopping in the beauty of the mountains with spectacular views? Want to see the works of artists without driving all over the countryside? We have just the arts and crafts sale for you! Several of the Coolfont Mountainside artists have joined together for the Coolfont Mountainside Arts and Crafts Tour November 6 and 7—Saturday 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM and Sunday 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM. A portion of the proceeds from sales of products with animal themes, jewelry, paintings, herbal remedies, pillows and international items will be donated to the Humane Society of Morgan Country. Items maybe purchased on site or custom orders for the holidays.

Our artists and craft specialists include Rosemary Bigelow, Richard Kaufman, Nancy Thompson, Elias and Mary Tamari, Phyllis Yingling, Mary Ellen Snyder and other local artists and crafts

Persons. Maps available at the Ice House Artists' Co-op Gallery, located at Independence & Mercer Streets, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411, 304-258-2300 and at www.coolfontmountainside.org.

*Richard Kaufman will also be showing his art at **Bath Bookworks** October 30-November 28.*

ATTENTION HOMEOWNERS

John Hobday and I will be inspecting septic tanks of homes on the central system during the coming weeks. (As is required by our wastewater discharge permit)

We will inform by letter all home owners whose tanks need pumping.

Also the December water bill will contain a West Virginia Department of Health flyer ,"Protecting Your Drinking Water from Contamination"

Elmer Broxson



CMA keeping your water and sewer system safe!

Meet New CMA President: Jim Thompson continued from page 1

There are currently openings for 2 two year positions on the nominating committee. Our pool beautification program under Mary Kay and Gordon Cloney has made incredible progress over the years and there are opportunites for trails and other recreational facilities. Hosting a potluck dinner or an open house next July is a good way to get started.

The board and a number of interested members toured parts of our CMA infrastructure on a beautiful day in September. This tour brought home the complexities of our community and the need to properly maintain our water, sewer and road systems.

Our CMA Covenants and Restrictions are desperately in need of significant revision. The last revision was in 1985 and some of the deficient sections are that the "Existing Property" section does not include the D, P, Q, R, S or T sections; there remains special member status and voting rights for the developer; and under strict interpretation of the General Provisions, we are severely limited in our ability to update the Covenants and Restrictions. Revisions can go into effect only once every ten years after a two-thirds membership approval and a three-year waiting period. The required filing deadline for any revisions is not later than December 13, 2005 to become effective on December 13, 2008, so it is not too early to begin the review and approval process. Given the rapid changes expected with Coolfont Resort and Morgan County, we should not overly constrain our ability to govern ourselves.

Firewise—We are working to become the first recognized Firewise Community in West Virginia. As you know we have completed theinitial assessment and homes have been assigned Hazard Ratings. The goals are to improve those ratings, secure approval of a CMA Firewise Plan and record enough volunteer hours to meet our required Firewise investment for the year.

We are currently in the process of upgrading our Web-site at :http://www.coolfontmountainside.org/ with a password protected section and other features. We would like your thoughts on how it can be improved. Bob Borchers, our webmaster, has been demonstrating his excellent web skills even from Maui!

We look forward to a productive year!

CMA COMMITTEE MEMBERS

Development Task Force— Carroll Yingling — Chair

DACC — Gordon Cloney— Chair

Roads — Elmer Broxson — Chair

Water — Jean Cohen — Chair

Social — Hallie Kerr — Chair

Recreation — Marie Barrett — Chair

Nominating — Dick Lehman — Chair

Firewise Board — Richard Kaufman — Chair

Trails — Barbara Meeker — Chair

John Hobday continues as our invaluable Operations Manager

Who is Jim Thompson, our new CMA President? Jim and Nancy Thompson have been CMA members since 1992 and completed their home at R-4 in 1998. Jim has been a member of the Development and Architectural Control Committee (DACC) since 1999 and was the chair from 2001-2004. He was elected president of the CMA Board of Directors in July 2004. He will be retiring in January after 30 years as an engineer for the Navy. Nancy has chaired and been a member of the nominating Committee and the Newcomer Breakfast Committee. Jim, Nancy and their two cats live in Arlington when not at Coolfont.

FIREWISE DAY ON THE MOUNTAINSIDE

The first annual Firewise Day will take place on Saturday, November 13, 12 noon at the barn. Todd Ruppenthal, chief of the Berkeley Springs Volunteer Fire Department, will join us. Chief Ruppenthal will be accompanied by a fire engine and crew.

An Official of the West Virginia Forestry Division, a representative from the Coolfont Resort and others will also be present. There will be a discussion and demonstrations of how to reduce the wildfire hazard and keep our homes safe. This is an exciting event for us as it will be the culmination of the steps we have been following to become the first official Firewise Community in West Virginia. It is important that we have a good turnout for the guests and for our own sake. Our Firewise Plan contains background information and what we intend to accomplish over the next year. The full text can be found on our web site: http://www.firewise.org

Richard Kaufman

Keep our community fire-free and beautiful!



Coolfont
Moountainside
Association

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www.coolfontmountainside.org
Lois Copeland, NL Editor

Our heartfelt good wishes go out to Laura Braun for a speedy recovery. Our thoughts are with you and your family.

The CMA Family

Editorial

I am Lois Copeland and will be your new newsletter editor. This is our first newsletter in many months and will be an abbreviated edition.
Since our last newsletter CMA has been very busy. Many endured a long drive to spend a beautiful and snowy winter weekend snuggled by the warmth of the woodburning stove and a room full of happy people.
Many of us participated in the pool cleanup and pool beautification day May 15, chaired by Gordon and Mary Kay Cloney. Volunteers were provided with lunch; food is a very useful bribe on the mountainside. Rick Picardi and Eileen Neely hosted the potluck dinner in their beautiful new home.
The following day the Newcomer's brunch, hosted by Hallie Kerr and her social committee, was well attended by new and old members.
Our annual meeting was held July 19th. Many pertinent issues were discussed. As is the custom the post annual meeting dinner was held in the barn.

Lois Copeland

Reminder from the Treasurer

PAY YOUR BILLS ON TIME AND AVOID PROBLEMS

Several of our members face disconnection of their water for failure to pay their water and sewer bills. The most recent bills were due September 18, 2004. We dislike disconnecting the water but the Public Service Commission requires that bills be paid on time.

Several of our members face the prospect of having a lien placed on their property for failure to pay the recent annual assessment which was due on August 17, 2004. A lien will hamper sale of the property and could be considered an unfavorable mark on one's credit rating.

The DACC is prohibited from approving construction or improvement plans when an outstanding balance exists. If there are questions please call me at 301-946-0668.

Paul Kagen

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Directory Updates

M-5 was sold by Robert and Dorothy Ladd to Jay and Anne Beckley

B-5 was sold by Jeri and Brian Rubin to current CMA members William and Sylvia McCrady



Paul not only protects our investment but our surroundings!